# 22 — Competitor and price benchmark

Real market data, gathered 26 August 2026. Every figure is sourced.

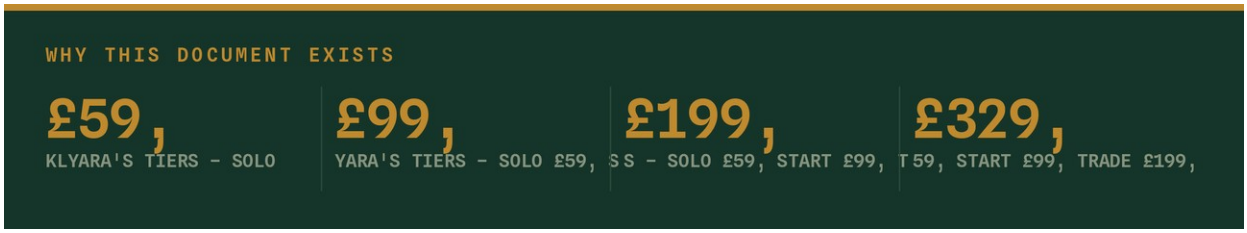
### Read this before using anything below

Klyara **cannot trade as a bookkeeper by way of business until AML supervision is in place** (docs/01, docs/06 §5). Everything in this document that offers, prices or sells the service is written for the day supervision lands. Before then, run the education-first and waitlist variants in docs/03 — the content, the guides and the free tools are all fine to publish now; the **"we do your books for £X a month" half is not**. Ask a client for a review only after you have lawfully done work for them. Delete this box on the day the licence arrives, and not before.

### In this part

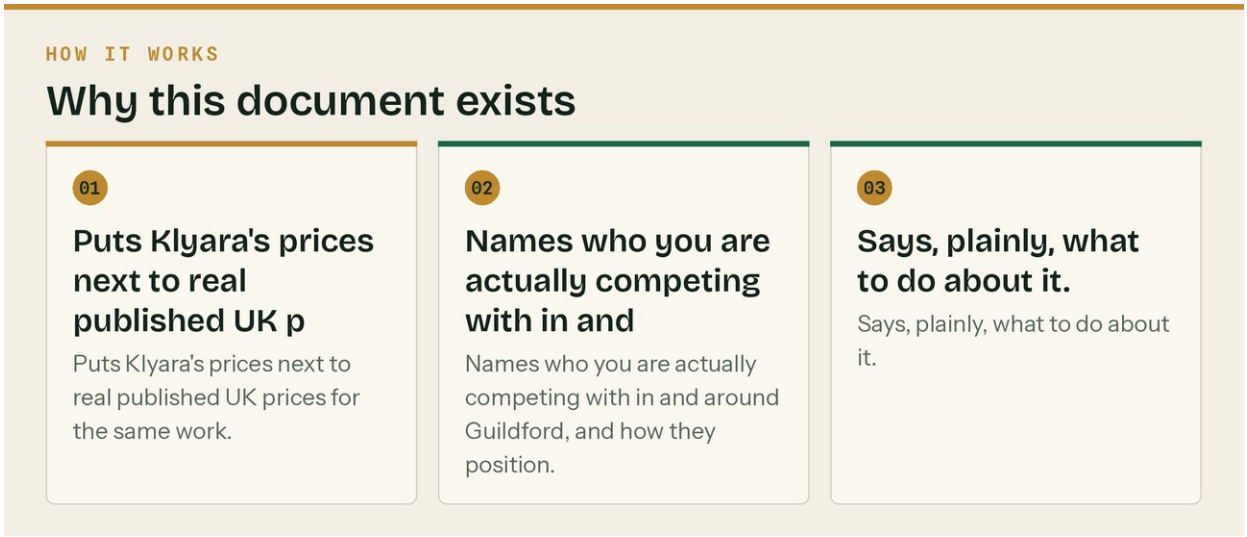
Real market data, gathered 26 August 2026. Every figure is sourced.

# Why this document exists




Klyara's tiers — Solo £59, Start £99, Trade £199, Pro £329, all plus VAT — were set before anybody checked what the market actually charges. This document checks. It does three things:

1. Puts Klyara's prices next to real published UK prices for the same work.
2. Names who you are actually competing with in and around Guildford, and how they position.
3. Says, plainly, what to do about it.




The same steps, in order.

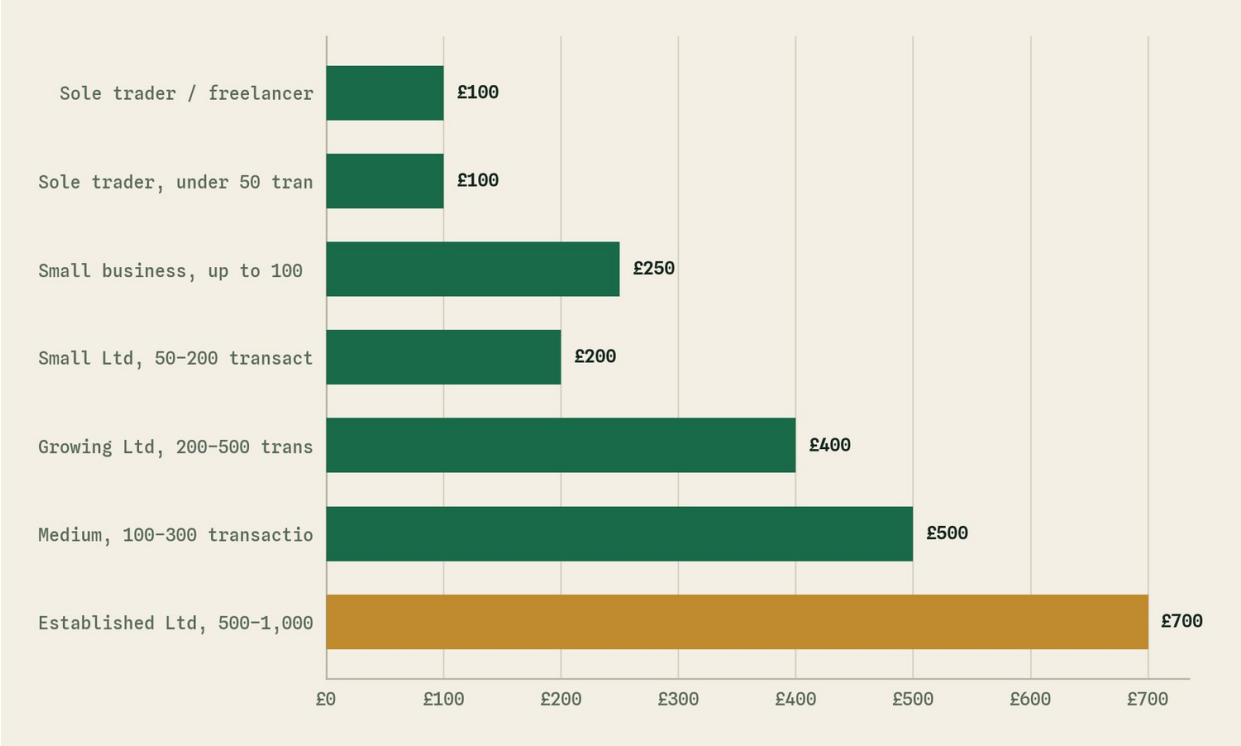
Every figure below came off a live page on 26 August 2026 and the URL is given. Prices move. Re-run this in January 2027 — it is a two-hour job and Day 84 of the plan has a slot for it.

# PART 1 — What the market charges




## General UK bookkeeping, fixed monthly fee

| BUSINESS SIZE | PUBLISHED MONTHLY RANGE | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Sole trader / freelancer** | £100–£250 | A One Outsourcing |
| **Sole trader, under 50 transactions** | £100–£200 + VAT | Gro |
| **Small business, up to 100 transactions** | £250–£500 | A One Outsourcing |
| **Small Ltd, 50–200 transactions** | £200–£400 + VAT | Gro |
| **Growing Ltd, 200–500 transactions** | £400–£700 + VAT | Gro |
| **Medium, 100–300 transactions** | £500–£950+ | A One Outsourcing |
| **Established Ltd, 500–1,000 transactions** | £700–£1,200 + VAT | Gro |




The same table as a picture. Established Ltd, 500–1,000 is the largest at £700.

## Hourly, for comparison

| LEVEL | RATE | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Junior / unqualified** | £18–£30/hr | A One Outsourcing · Gro |
| **Qualified AAT or ICB** | £30–£45/hr | A One Outsourcing · Gro |
| **Xero-certified senior** | £40–£50 + VAT/hr | Gro |
| **South East regional average** | £28–£50/hr | A One Outsourcing |



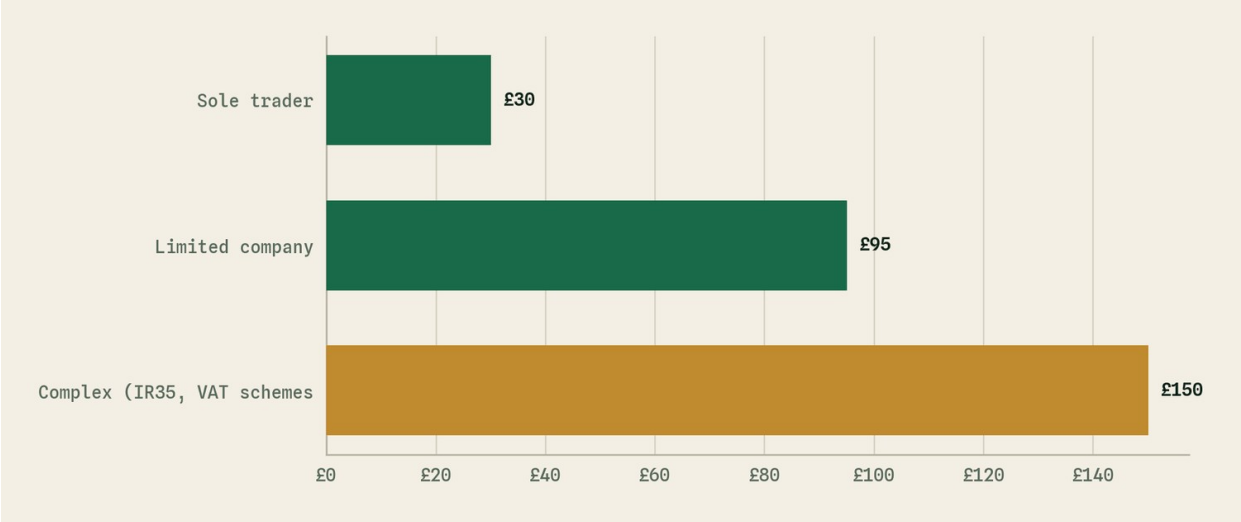
The same table as a picture. Xero-certified senior is the largest at £40.

## Construction and CIS specifically — the important table

| ITEM | PUBLISHED PRICE | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **CIS premium over standard bookkeeping** | **15–25%** | A One Outsourcing |
| **Monthly CIS return management, standalone** | **£80–£200/month** | A One Outsourcing |
| **CIS returns, per submission** | £15–£30 | Gro |
| **Monthly CIS returns** | **from £95/month** | LOYALS |
| **Light bookkeeping** | from £125/month | LOYALS |
| **Contractor with subcontractors, bundled** | **£300–£500/month** | LOYALS |
| **Multi-trade business, bundled** | £600–£1,500/month | LOYALS |
| **CIS subcontractor self assessment** | £350/year fixed | LOYALS |
| **Limited co, solo director** | £1,200–£2,200/year | LOYALS |
| **MTD for Income Tax** | £150/quarter (£600/yr) | LOYALS |
| **VAT returns** | from £195/quarter | LOYALS |
| **Gross payment status application** | £400 one-off | LOYALS |
| **Reverse charge VAT setup** | £250 one-off | LOYALS |
| **VAT returns, general market** | £25–£150 per return | A One · Gro |
| **Payroll, per employee** | £4–£6 per payslip | Gro |
| **Payroll, 1–10 employees** | £20–£80/month | A One Outsourcing |
| **Data migration / setup** | £200–£800 | A One Outsourcing |

## Contractor accountants, monthly

| STRUCTURE | RANGE | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Sole trader** | £30–£70/month | Accounting Firms |
| **Limited company** | £95–£150/month | Accounting Firms |
| **Complex (IR35, VAT schemes)** | £150–£230+/month | Accounting Firms |



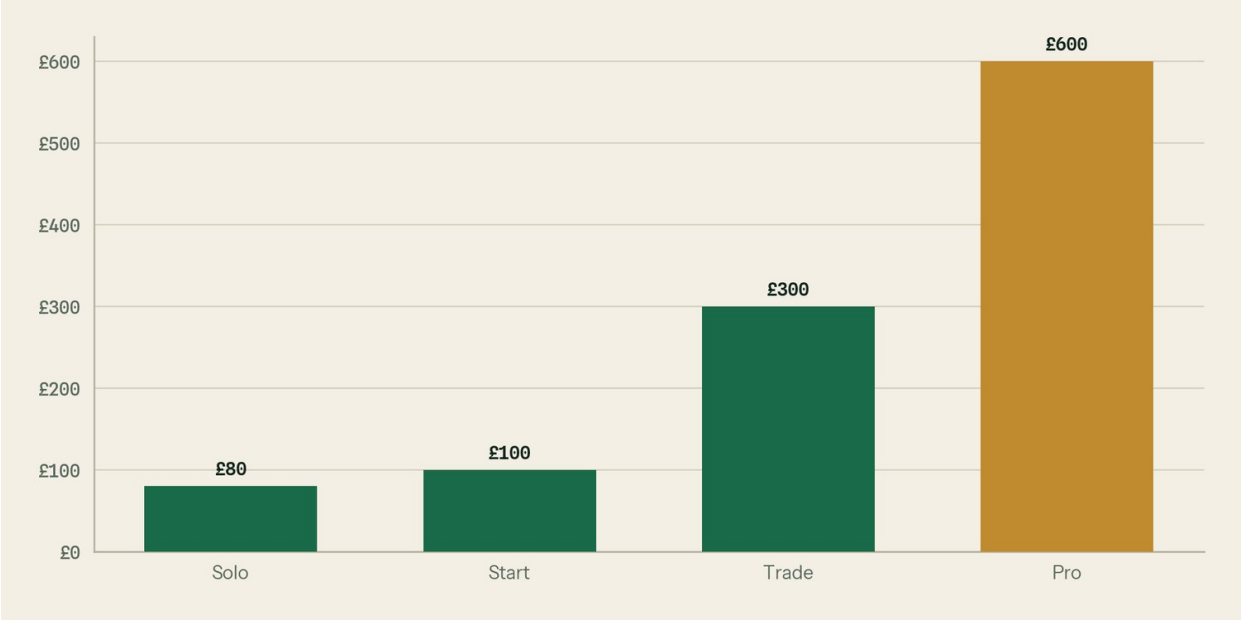

The same table as a picture. Complex (IR35, VAT schemes is the largest at £150.

# PART 2 — Where Klyara sits

PART 2 - WHERE KLYARA SITS

£59 SOLO | £80 SOLO £59 CIS RETURNS ALONE | £200 LO £59 CIS RETURNS ALONE: | £95 URNS ALONE: £80–£200/MO -

| KLYARA TIER | PRICE + VAT | NEAREST PUBLISHED COMPARATOR | VERDICT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Solo** | £59 | CIS returns alone: £80–£200/mo · from £95/mo | **Below the price of the CIS return on its own** |
| **Start** | £99 | Sole trader bookkeeping £100–£250 | Bottom of the range, before the CIS premium |
| **Trade** | £199 | Contractor-with-subbies bundle £300–£500 | **£101–£301/month under the direct comparator** |
| **Pro** | £329 | Multi-trade bundle £600–£1,500 | Roughly half the bottom of the range |




The same table as a picture. Pro is the largest at £600.

Three things fall out of that, and none of them are comfortable.

**One. Solo at £59 is priced below the cost of the single service inside it.** The cheapest published monthly CIS return management in this research is £95, and the general range starts at £80. Solo

includes CIS returns *and* bookkeeping *and* the software *and* the statements. It is not a cheap tier; it is a loss leader, and it needs to be treated as one deliberately rather than accidentally.

**Two. Trade is the tier that is most obviously mispriced.** LOYALS publishes £300–£500 a month for exactly the client Trade is aimed at — a contractor paying subcontractors. Trade is £199. That is a discount of a third to two thirds against a firm that is not local, not in Surrey, and by its own description charges more because it is chartered.

**Three. The bundle economics are on Klyara's side and are not being used.** Bought separately at published rates, a Trade client's work — light bookkeeping (from £125) + CIS returns (from £95) + VAT quarterly (from £195/qtr, so £65/mo) — is £285/month before payroll, before MTD, before the year-end pack. Trade sells all of that for £199. The saving is real and it is roughly £86–£300 a month. **Nobody is being told this number.** It belongs on the pricing page, in the proposal, and in the third minute of every discovery call.

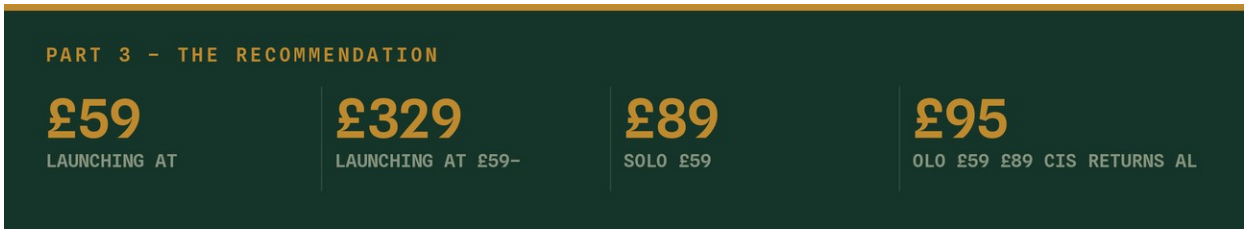
### The Surrey adjustment

Two of the sources give a South East premium: hourly rates in the South East run £28–£50 against a £22–£42 Midlands and North West band. That is roughly a 20% regional uplift. Klyara is priced in Guildford — one of the more expensive towns in one of the more expensive counties — at national *floor* rates. There is no version of this where £59 reads as anything other than surprisingly cheap, and docs/11 already flagged that cheap in Surrey can read as unqualified.

**The line that matters**

One. Solo at £59 is priced below the cost of the single service inside it.

# PART 3 — The recommendation




**Do not change the launch prices. Change the framing, and put a dated increase in the diary.**

The reasoning, in order.

Launching at £59–£329 with nothing to show — no reviews, no case studies, no track record, no licence yet displayed — is defensible. Price is doing a job right now: it is buying the first ten clients cheaply, and the first ten clients are worth more as proof than as revenue. Raising prices before you have a single Google review would be trading the one advantage you currently hold.

But three things have to be true or the low price becomes permanent:

4. **The price is stated as an introductory rate from day one.** Not "our prices", but "founding client rate, held for twelve months from the date you join". The wording is in §Pricing language below. This costs nothing now and buys the entire increase later.
5. **The comparison number appears everywhere.** "Bought separately, this work is £285 a month at published market rates" is the single most persuasive sentence available, and it is true and sourced. Cheap without a reference point reads as low quality. Cheap against a stated £285 reads as a good deal from someone who knows what they are doing.
6. **The increase is diarised now, not decided later.** Review on **1 September 2027**. Founding clients keep their rate to their twelve-month anniversary and then move to the standard rate, with sixty days' written notice. New clients from the review date pay the new rate.

HOW IT WORKS

## PART 3 – The recommendation

01

### **The price is stated as an introductory rate fr

The wording is in  Pricing language below. This costs nothing now and buys the entire increase later.

02

### **The comparison number appears everywhere.** "B

Cheap without a reference point reads as low quality. Cheap against a stated £285 reads as a good deal from someone who knows what they are doing.

03

### **The increase is diarised now, not decided late

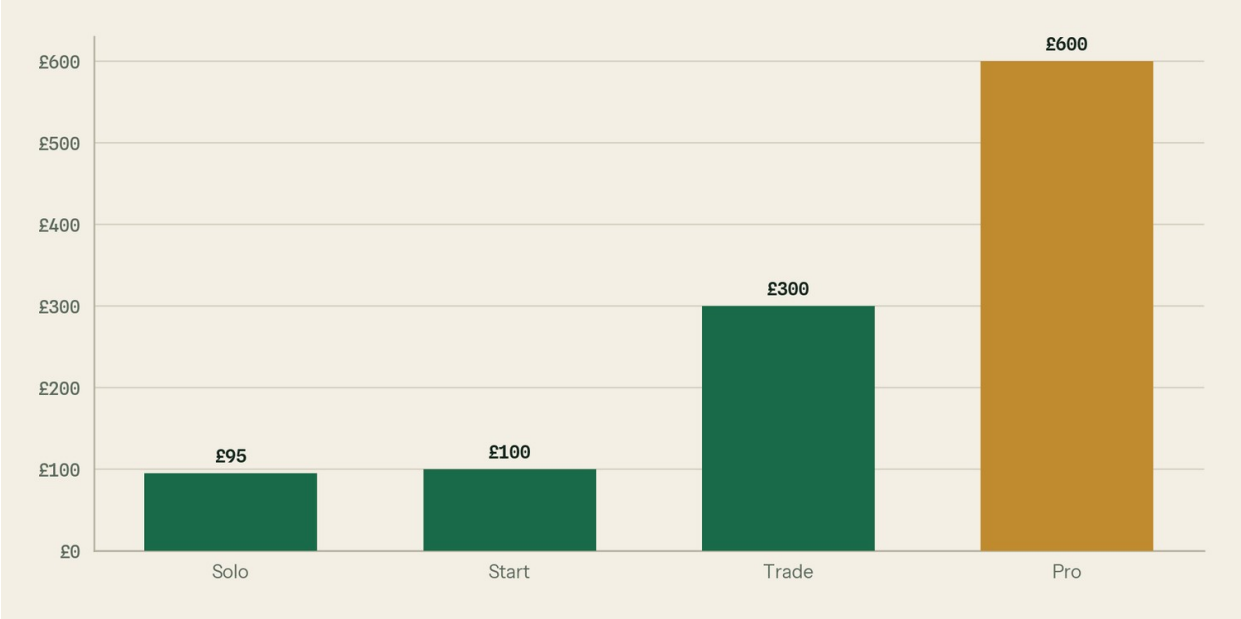
Founding clients keep their rate to their twelve-month anniversary and then move to the standard rate, with sixty days' written notice. New clients fr

The same steps, in order.

### The target prices at the September 2027 review

Set against the comparator, not against a percentage of the old price.

| TIER | NOW | SEPT 2027 TARGET | COMPARATOR IT SHOULD SIT UNDER |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Solo** | £59 | £89 | CIS returns alone, £95–£200 |
| **Start** | £99 | £149 | Sole trader bookkeeping, £100–£250 |
| **Trade** | £199 | £279 | Contractor bundle, £300–£500 |
| **Pro** | £329 | £449 | Multi-trade bundle, £600–£1,500 |



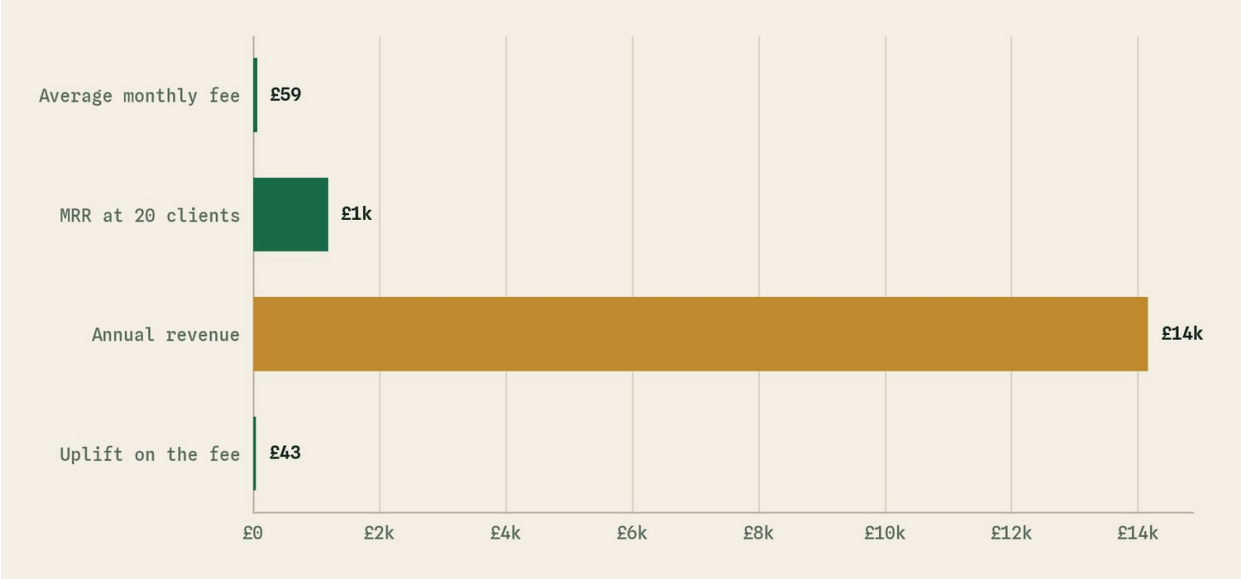

The same table as a picture. Pro is the largest at £600.

Every one of those still undercuts the published comparator. That is the point: the position is *better value than the specialists*, not *cheapest available*. Those are different businesses.

### What the increase is actually worth — and what it can survive

Modelled in tools/Klyara-KPI-Tracker-and-Model.xlsx, on the **Price scenario** sheet. On the current tier mix (35% Solo, 25% Start, 30% Trade, 10% Pro) and twenty clients:

| | FOUNDING RATE | TARGET RATE | DIFFERENCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Average monthly fee** | £138 | £197 | **+£59** |
| **MRR at 20 clients** | £2,760 | £3,940 | +£1,180 |
| **Annual revenue** | £33,120 | £47,280 | **+£14,160** |
| **Uplift on the fee** | | | 42.8% |




The same table as a picture. Annual revenue is the largest at £14,160.

**And the number that actually settles the argument: you could lose five clients out of twenty over the increase and still be ahead.** Break-even is 14.01 clients, so the sixth one takes you £2 a month below where you started — which is why the sentence says five. docs/21 targets 90% acceptance on a properly-notified increase, which would be two.

That asymmetry is why the founding-rate wording matters so much and why it costs nothing to add today. The downside of the increase is bounded at two clients. The upside is fourteen thousand pounds a year on a twenty-client book, and you have five clients of headroom before it even costs you anything.

Change the client count on that sheet to model it at whatever size the book actually reaches.

## What to do this week

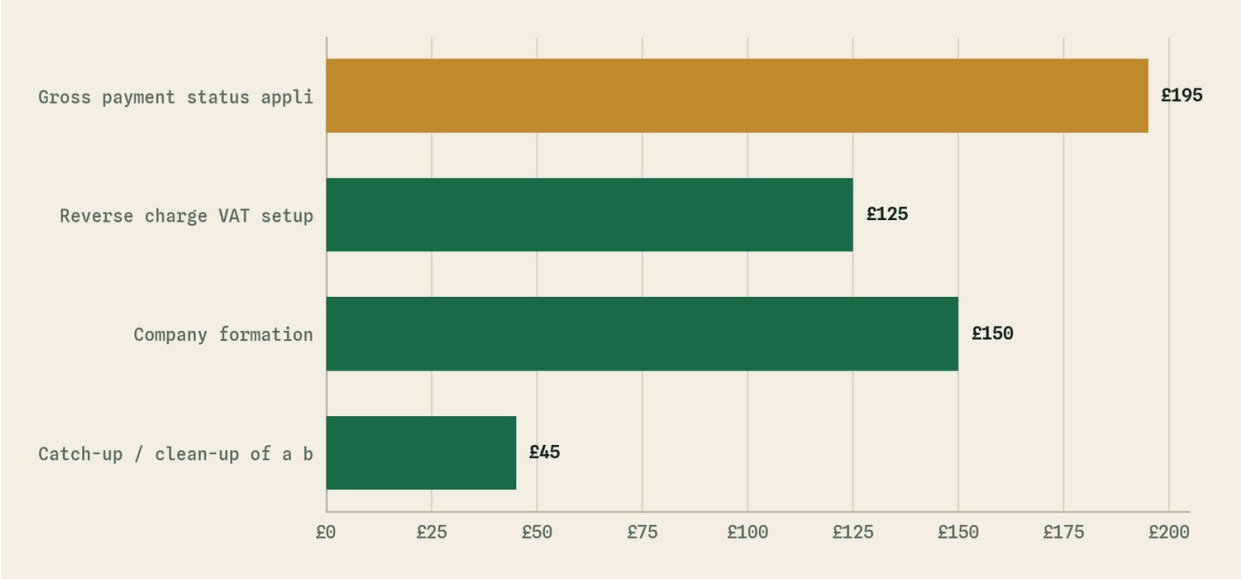
- **Done.** "Founding client rate" wording is on web/pricing.html, in the proposal PDF and in the Schedule of Services. The £285 comparison is on the pricing page and in the proposal.
- Diarise the price review for **1 September 2027**. This is the one thing on the list that still needs a human to do it.
- Add the one-off services below to the price list. They are pure margin and everyone else charges for them.

## One-off services Klyara currently gives away

LOYALS charges for all three. Klyara should charge for at least the first two.

| SERVICE | LOYALS PRICE | SUGGESTED KLYARA PRICE |
|---|---|---|
| **Gross payment status application** | £400 | **£195**, or free on Trade and Pro |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Reverse charge VAT setup** | £250 | **£125**, or free at onboarding |
| **Company formation** | from £400 | £150, or refer it out |
| **Catch-up / clean-up of a bad set of books** | (setup £200–£800) | **£45/hour, quoted after a look** |




The same table as a picture. Gross payment status appli is the largest at £195.

The gross payment status application is the strongest of these. It is a defined piece of work with a number attached to it — docs/15 puts the value to the client at around £24,000 of cash flow — and £195 against £400 is an easy sell. It is also a superb first transaction with a client who is not ready to move their whole bookkeeping yet.

# PART 4 — Who you are actually competing with in Guildford




Searched 26 August 2026 on "CIS bookkeeping construction accountant Guildford Surrey monthly fee". These are the firms that surface. This is the page one you are trying to get onto.

| FIRM | WHAT THEY ARE | PUBLISHES PRICES? | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Accountant for Construction (Guildford page)** | National site with a Guildford landing page | No — "free no obligation quote" | Claims "the go-to experts" and "leading provider". Two five-star testimonials on the page. Construction-only positioning, same as Klyara. **This is the closest competitor.** |
| **Graham Barnes Accountant** | Local Guildford accountant with a builders page | No | Generalist with a construction page |
| **Castle Accounts** | "Accountants For Builders Guildford — Low Cost Fixed Fees" | Page blocked automated access | Competing explicitly on low fixed fees. Worth a manual look. |
| **CloudCo Books** | CIS tax return service, Guildford page | No | Return-only, not a back office |
| **Guildford Accounting** | CIS accountants service page | No | |
| **Buttmiller, Treetops, AccFirm** | General Guildford / Surrey accountants | No | Not construction specialists |
| **Blue Matrix** | Guildford bookkeeping, construction listed as a sector, Xero Gold Partner | **A headline figure only** | Advertises "from as little as £35 per month" plus VAT, with no tiers, no transaction limits and no statement of what is in it. CIS is not mentioned on |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | the Guildford page at all. |
| **dns accountants** | National, Guildford landing page | No | High domain authority. Will outrank you on generic terms. |
| **David Howard** | Surrey, construction and property sector page | No | Established local practice |
| **Ordinem Finance** | Construction accountants, builders and contractors | No | |
| **LOYALS** | London construction and CIS accountants | **Yes, in detail** | Not local, but the price benchmark |

## The four things this tells you

**Almost nobody publishes a real price.** Of the thirteen firms in the table above, exactly one published a full price list and it was the London one. One local firm — Blue Matrix — publishes a headline "from as little as £35 per month", with no tiers, no scope and no mention of CIS. Everyone else makes you fill in a form.

That is still the gap, and it is a large one: a subcontractor at 7pm wants to know whether this costs £80 or £800 before he gives anybody his phone number. But **the claim has to be worded honestly**, because "nobody round here publishes prices" is not quite true and a competitor could say so. The accurate line, and the one now on web/pricing.html, is:

> **Almost none of them publish anything — you fill in a form and wait. Th**
>
> number shows "from" and nothing behind it.

**The £35 headline needs an answer, and it is not "we are worth more".** It is three questions, which are now a published FAQ on the pricing page: is that a "from" price with the real quote arriving after you hand over your number; are the CIS returns in it or billed per submission at £15–£30 a time; and is the software subscription in the fee and in whose name. A genuinely cheaper bookkeeper exists. A cheaper-*looking* one is much more common, and those three questions separate them.

**"Construction specialist" is a claim, not a moat.** The nearest competitor uses the same words Klyara does. The difference has to be visible in thirty seconds, and the honest differences are: published prices, a named person who answers the phone, a Guildford address, and content that demonstrates the specialism rather than asserting it. Twelve guide pages, four working tools and a published price list do more work here than any strapline.

**The nearest competitor is a national site with a town-name page.** That is beatable on local signals — a real Google Business Profile with real reviews, a Guildford phone number, and pages that mention

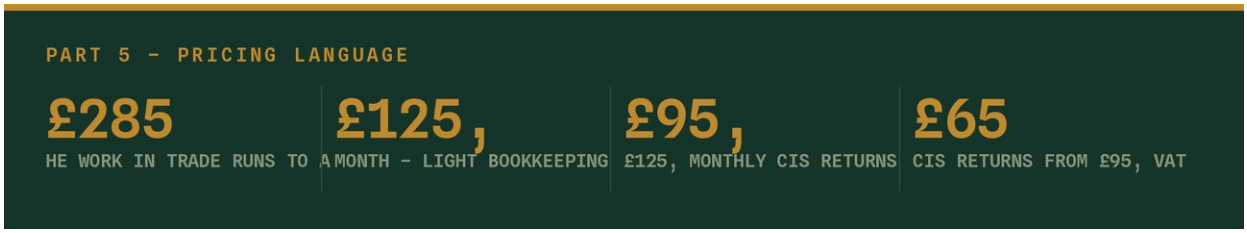
Woking, Godalming, Farnham and Cranleigh because you actually work there. It is not beatable on domain authority. Compete where you can win.

**Testimonials on a competitor's page are two names and five stars.** Klyara's homepage currently carries invented testimonials and that has to be fixed before launch — it is flagged in docs/20 as the highest-severity item and it is a banned practice under the DMCC Act 2024. The competitive point is that the bar here is *low*: two real, named, verifiable reviews would already match the firm currently ranking. There is no need for fifteen.

### The line that matters

The £35 headline needs an answer, and it is not "we are worth more".

# PART 5 — Pricing language




Copy these. They are written to be said out loud.

**On the website, under the tiers**

> **Founding client rate. Whatever you join on, that price is held for twe**
>
> date. Bought separately at published market rates, the work in Trade runs to about £285 a month — light bookkeeping from £125, monthly CIS returns from £95, VAT from £65. We do it all for £199.

**When someone says it seems cheap**

> **It is cheap, and there is a reason rather than a catch. We do one indu**
>
> learning your scheme on your time — the CIS work that takes a general practice half a day takes us twenty minutes because we do forty of them a month. And we are new. You are getting a founding rate because your review is worth more to us right now than the difference in fee.

**When someone says another firm quoted less**

> **Ask them two things. Is the CIS return in that price or billed per sub**
>
> time is normal. And is the software subscription in the fee or on top. Most of the cheap quotes in this trade are cheap because the CIS is extra, and CIS is the whole reason you are calling.

**When someone asks why it is not free like their bank's app**

> **Because the app does not ring HMRC to verify a subcontractor, does not**
>
> out before the deduction, and does not file anything on the 19th. It records what happened. We are the bit that makes sure the right thing happened.

**At the twelve-month increase**

**Your founding rate runs to [date]. From [date + 60 days] you will move**

£[x] a month. Everything in the service stays the same. If that does not work, tell me now and we will talk about the scope rather than have you leave over £40.

# Sources

All accessed 26 August 2026.


- A One Outsourcing — How Much Does Bookkeeping Cost in the UK? 2026 Pricing Guide & Fees — https://www.aoneoutsourcing.uk/blog/how-much-does-bookkeeping-cost-in-the-uk
- Gro — How Much Does a Bookkeeper Cost UK? 2026 Fees Guide — https://wearegro.co.uk/blog/how-much-does-a-bookkeeper-cost-uk-2026-guide
- LOYALS — Construction Accountants London: CIS, Ltd Co, Trades — https://www.loyals.uk/industries/construction-cis-accountants
- Accounting Firms — Contractor Accountant Fees: How Much Should You Pay in 2026? — https://www.accountingfirms.co.uk/blog/contractor-accountant-fees/
- Accountant for Construction — Guildford — https://accountantforconstruction.co.uk/near-me/surrey-guildford/
- Castle Accounts — Guildford — https://castleaccounts.co.uk/guildford/ (returned 403 to automated access; check manually)
- Graham Barnes Accountant — Guildford — https://grahambarnesaccountant.co.uk/guildford/
- CloudCo Books — CIS Return Guildford — https://www.cloudcobooks.co.uk/cis-return-guildford/
- Guildford Accounting — CIS Accountants — https://guildfordaccounting.com/services/cis-accountants/
- HMRC — CIS 340, Construction Industry Scheme guide — https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/construction-industry-scheme-cis-340/construction-industry-scheme-a-guide-for-contractors-and-subcontractors-cis-340
- Blue Matrix — Bookkeeping services, Guildford — https://www.bluematrix.co.uk/bookkeeping-services-guildford-surrey/
- dns accountants — Accountants in Guildford — https://www.dnsassociates.co.uk/accountants-in-guildford
- David Howard — Construction, trades and property — https://www.davidhoward.co.uk/construction-trades-property
- Ordinem Finance — Construction accountants — https://www.ordinemfinance.co.uk/who-we-work-with/construction-accountants/
- Experi — CIS deduction calculator — https://www.experi.co.uk/tools/cis-deduction-calculator
- Other free CIS calculators surveyed: taxcalculate.co.uk, uktax.tools, complys.co.uk, quoteledger.co.uk, fastjobs.uk, toolfy.io, graftum.com

AT A GLANCE

## The short version

- A One Outsourcing – How Much Does Bookke
- Gro – How Much Does a Bookkeeper Cost UK
- LOYALS – Construction Accountants London
- Accounting Firms – Contractor Accountant
- Accountant for Construction – Guildford
- Castle Accounts – Guildford – https://ca

PROGRESS

**Part 8 of 9 – Sources** 89%

How far through this document you are

# PART 6 — The free-tools landscape

Checked the same day, because web/tools.html was built on an assumption that turned out to be half wrong.

**Searched:** "best free CIS deduction calculator UK subcontractor labour materials".

At least eight free CIS calculators rank for this, including Experi, TaxCalculate, UK Tax Tools, Complys, QuoteLedger, Fastjobs, Toolfy and Graftum. Several handle the labour/materials split properly — Experi's, for instance, takes gross, labour and materials separately and states plainly that CIS applies to labour only. Most need no sign-up.

**So "a free CIS calculator" is not a differentiator and the page should not claim it is.** The copy has been corrected accordingly.

**What is genuinely unusual is the set.** None of those eight also answers *do I charge VAT on this invoice*, *what are my unfiled returns costing*, and *when does MTD start for me*. Those three questions, plus the MTD date, arrive in the same week for the same person, and having them on one page, from a firm that only does construction, is a defensible position in a way that a lone calculator is not.

**What this means for the SEO plan.** Do not target "CIS calculator" — it is saturated and the incumbents have years of links. Target the combinations and the intent nobody else serves:

| TARGET INSTEAD | WHY |
|---|---|
| **"do I charge VAT on this invoice construction"** | The reverse charge decision tool. Almost nothing serves this as a tool. |
| **"how much are my late CIS returns costing"** | The penalty estimator. Fear-driven, high intent, no competitor tool. |
| **"am I in Making Tax Digital CIS subcontractor"** | The gross-income trap. Already the highest-intent page in the set. |
| **"CIS calculator Guildford / Surrey"** | Local qualifier. The national tools do not compete locally. |
| **"end user declaration template"** | docs/08 already flags template pages as passive link earners. |

**Re-run date: January 2027.** Prices in this market move annually and two of these sources re-publish their guides each year.

**The line that matters**

So "a free CIS calculator" is not a differentiator and the page should not claim it is.

### Also worth knowing

Several handle the labour/materials split properly — Experi's, for instance, takes gross, labour and materials separately and states plainly that CIS applies to labour only.

PROGRESS

**Part 9 of 9 – PART 6 – The free-tools landscape** 100%

How far through this document you are